

FULL CASE STUDY

PUBLIC-SAFE

CallNYC.org

Civic data to resident-facing guidance

Independently built an archived civic-data prototype translating constituent-services open data into resident-facing next-step guidance.

Context

On January 30, 2016, Civic Hall hosted a New York City Council hackathon focused on constituent services; Civic Hall had announced it for 1-3 p.m. ¹ An event-day New York City Council post described the gathering as its first CouncilStat hackathon. ² After the full CouncilStat dataset became public, Jamie independently built CallNYC.org as a resident-facing interpretation of the records. ³

The public problem was familiar: data existed, but the path from a resident's issue to a useful next step was not always easy to see. A spreadsheet or dataset can be technically public and still be hard for a person to use.

What was unclear

Constituent-services data carried civic signal, but residents needed a translation layer. What issue is this? Which office or district context might matter? What next step is reasonable? What should be treated as general guidance rather than official service direction?

The project also needed a strong disclaimer. CallNYC was independently developed, not an official City Council product, not a current civic service, not legal guidance, and not a replacement for emergency or agency channels. It is now an archived civic-tech prototype showing how public data could be made more navigable.

What became usable

The prototype organized open data into issue pathways, district context, and resident-facing guidance. It treated data translation as a product and information-architecture problem: the resident should not have to understand the whole dataset before seeing a next step.

The public-safe framing today is historical. The project shows civic-data translation, open-data product thinking, public interface design, and the ability to move from an event context into a working independent prototype.

What I did

Jamie built the prototype, shaped the issue pathways, translated data into public-facing guidance patterns, and connected civic-data structure to a resident-readable interface.

The work required choosing what not to claim. A prototype can demonstrate a pattern without pretending to be an official service. The page therefore keeps the archived status visible and avoids current-service language.

How people used it

Residents and civic-tech observers could see how an issue might connect to district context, constituent-service categories, or possible civic next steps. The project also gave collaborators a concrete surface for discussing what useful public guidance could look like.

For product and operations teams, the transferable pattern is the same one visible elsewhere in Jamie's work: take a scattered or expert-facing source, map what a user needs to do, and create a pathway that is easier to enter.

Outcome / evidence

The project was a historical civic-tech demo built from CouncilStat constituent-services open data. It included public issue pages, resident-facing guidance, and an independent civic-data interpretation layer.

Politico New York covered CallNYC in 2016 as a website for exploring City Council constituent-services data. Public-safe screenshots and additional archive links should still be confirmed before launch.

A bounded archival search did not recover a dedicated Civic Hall calendar listing or event-detail page for the gathering.^{[4](#)} This is a documented search result, not proof that no page ever existed.

Transferable proof

This case matters for civic technology and public-facing tools because it shows open-data translation into a usable public interface.

It matters for product operations because the work moved from dataset to user pathway, with disclaimers and scope boundaries built into the surface.

It matters for implementation because it demonstrates a small but complete civic prototype: data source, information architecture, interface, and public-safe guidance.

Sources

1. January 2016 Civic Hall announcement

Civic Hall announced a January 30, 2016 New York City Council hackathon focused on constituent services for 1-3 p.m.; a Wayback capture preserves the post in Civic Hall's embedded feed.

- Civic Hall. Civic Hall post announcing a January 30, 2016 NYC Council hackathon (01/29/2016). Announces January 30, 1-3 p.m., for a New York City Council hackathon focused on constituent services. [Original Civic Hall post \(https://x.com/CivicHall/status/693124020917522433\)](https://x.com/CivicHall/status/693124020917522433)
[Wayback-captured Civic Hall embedded feed \(https://web.archive.org/web/20160131004601/http://civichall.org/events/page/2/\)](https://web.archive.org/web/20160131004601/http://civichall.org/events/page/2/)
- Civic Hall events page preserving its embedded social feed (01/31/2016). Archived Civic Hall page preserving the relevant Civic Hall and NYC Council posts inside an embedded social feed. [January 31, 2016 Wayback capture \(https://web.archive.org/web/20160131004601/http://civichall.org/events/page/2/\)](https://web.archive.org/web/20160131004601/http://civichall.org/events/page/2/)

Limits: The announced hours do not independently establish actual event duration. The archived feed is not a recovered event listing.

2. CouncilStat wording and recovered event branding

The New York City Council described the Civic Hall gathering as its first CouncilStat hackathon; the recovered Council-branded graphic reads 'New York City Council Hackathon.'

- New York City Council. New York City Council event-day post from Civic Hall (01/30/2016). Event-day post identifying the gathering at Civic Hall as the Council's first #CouncilStat hackathon. [Original NYC Council post \(https://x.com/NYCCouncil/status/693509031768506368\)](https://x.com/NYCCouncil/status/693509031768506368)
[Wayback-captured Civic Hall embedded feed \(https://web.archive.org/web/20160131004601/http://civichall.org/events/page/2/\)](https://web.archive.org/web/20160131004601/http://civichall.org/events/page/2/)

- New York City Council / Civic Hall. New York City Council Hackathon promotional graphic. Council-branded graphic reading 'New York City Council Hackathon' and 'labs.council.nyc.'

Promotional graphic (<https://pbs.twimg.com/media/CZ5m-mAWwAA42td.png:large>)

Wayback-captured Civic Hall embedded feed

(<https://web.archive.org/web/20160131004601/http://civichall.org/events/page/2/>)

Limits: The Council wording does not establish a first civic-data hackathon of every kind. The graphic does not establish a longer formal registration title.

3. Independent CallNYC follow-on

Politico New York documents the sequence from the Civic Hall gathering to the full data release and Jamie's independent CallNYC development; the public repository preserves the implementation.

- Miranda Neubauer. Website provides new information about council members' focus (03/14/2016). Contemporaneous coverage connects the Civic Hall gathering, the later full CouncilStat release, and Jamie's independent development of CallNYC.

Archived Politico New York PDF (<https://callnyc.org/data/media/Politico-Website-provides-new-information-about-council-members-focus.pdf>)

- openhouse. CallNYC source repository. Public repository preserving the implementation of the independent, archived CallNYC prototype.

Public CallNYC repository (<https://github.com/openhouse/CallNYC>)

Limits: CallNYC was not an official Council product, commissioned service, or formal hackathon submission.

4. Bounded Civic Hall archive search

A bounded Wayback CDX search did not recover a dedicated Civic Hall calendar listing or event-detail page for the gathering.

- **Research audit.** No dedicated calendar listing or event-detail page was recovered. Civic Hall site evidence survives through an embedded social feed, not through a recovered event page.

Limits: Not recovered does not prove that no page ever existed or that no external registration page was available.

At a glance

ROLE	YEARS
Civic-Tech Builder & Product Translator	2016
CONTEXT	STATUS

Civic Prototype

VISIBILITY

public-safe

TAGS

Civic Technology

Open Data

Web Systems

Implementation

Public-Facing Tools

Full case study

ROLE FIT

Civic technology, product translation, open-data workflows, resident guidance, and public-facing web systems.

Visibility

This page is marked **public-safe**. Current status: Archived prototype. Public-safe screenshots pending.

[Download resume](#)

[Contact Jamie](#)

Primary artifacts

prototype

guide

map

press

Artifact gallery

PROTOTYPE / 01

Issue pathway prototype

Public-facing page patterns that moved from constituent issue to relevant office, district context, and possible next step.

MAP / 02

Open-data translation layer

An independent civic-data interpretation layer built after the January 2016 New York City Council CouncilStat hackathon at Civic Hall.

PRESS / 03

Archived press note

Politico New York covered CallNYC in 2016 as a public way to explore City Council constituent-services data.

Known / Open / Protected

Known

CallNYC translated civic open data into issue pathways and resident-facing guidance as an archived prototype with 2016 Politico New York coverage.

Open

Public-safe screenshots and additional archive links need Jamie approval before publication.

Protected

No current-service claims, official city affiliation claims, private user data, or unverified guidance are published.

Care note / limits

Archived civic-data prototype. Not an official or current City Council service, legal service, emergency service, or comprehensive civic guidance source.

Public-safety note

This page must make the archived and unofficial status visible wherever the project is summarized.

Source layer

CouncilStat / constituent-services open data, archived project context, verified Politico New York coverage, public GitHub repository, and public-safe screenshots pending.

Public links

[Politico New York archived PDF](#)

[GitHub repository](#)

Credits

- Jamie Burkart
- Civic-data collaborators

Jamie Burkart

Technical Project Manager - Product Operations & Implementation.
Public-safe portfolio, civic notebook, and future living archive.

[Work](#) [Technical Operations](#) [Resume](#)

[Contact](#) [Colophon](#)